

WHY BIOLOGY

The soil beneath
your farm is alive.

COMMUNITY

Join a global community
of Soil Food Web
farmers and consultants.



**Soil Food Web
Foundation**

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

A web of bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes, and microarthropods feeds plants, builds soil, stores carbon, and cleans water *when it is intact*.

What biologically complete, properly-structured soil does:



CYCLES
NUTRIENTS



CREATES
SOIL
STRUCTURE



INHIBITS
WEED
PRESSURE



REDUCES
PESTS AND
DISEASE

For forty-five years, Dr. Elaine Ingham mapped the Soil Food Web and taught the world to restore it. Today we train farmers, and the people who work with them, to move from chemical inputs to biology.



A mentor teaching on working land.

Our community includes farmers, consultants, gardeners, and people who care about nutrient-rich food. It's easy to find your place in this movement. Reach out to discover opportunities to join us as a student, volunteer, ambassador, donor, or partner.



Learn more

Curious about the Soil Food Web approach? Visit our website to explore our courses, workshops, and free resources. Learn how soil biology supports healthy plants and discover ways to get involved.

soilfoodweb.com

Grow your own biology.

You can grow the soil biology your crops need, on your own land, from locally-sourced materials, and spend less on inputs.

132+

Countries in our student and practitioner community

10,000+

Individuals enrolled in our programs

45

Years of soil biology research behind the method

Healing soil.
Feeding humanity.
Restoring the living world.

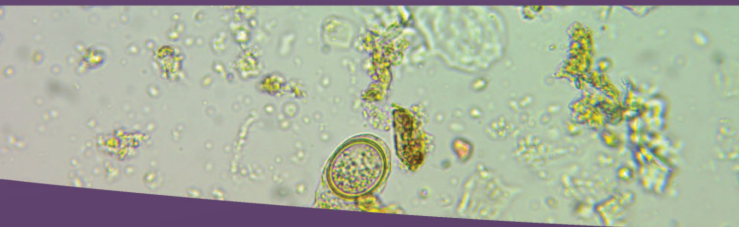
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MICROSCOPY

See what lives in your soil.



Testate amoeba, 40x objective. Photograph: Joy Kaluf.

Every recommendation starts with a biological analysis under a microscope. You'll learn to take a microbial count, which names what is present in your soil or compost sample and their relative numbers: bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes, and microarthropods.

The count shows you what your soil is missing. After you add it, you measure again to confirm microbial counts are going in the expected directions.

You can learn this in our Soil Microscopy program, which also prepares you for a career in soil biology analysis as an SFW Lab-Technician.

COMPOSTING AND LIQUID AMENDMENTS

Make your own biology on your farm.



A workshop group around a finished compost pile.

The basic methodology is universal; the application is based upon locally-sourced materials. You'll learn to produce high-quality BioComplete™ compost and biological liquid amendments, and to apply them to rebalance the microbial content of your soil.

You can learn this in our BioComplete™ Compost Production and Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial programs. You can also join an Accelerator Workshop, an immersive, two-week, hands-on intensive where you produce compost and liquid amendments live, on a partner's land.

HOLISTIC MANAGEMENT

Growers are already implementing the Soil Food Web Approach at every scale.



Agroecology plots at Rancho Cacachilas.

Holistic management means planning your whole operation around the biology in your soil. We help you convert your current operations to the Soil Food Web Approach, at any scale.

Nick Padwick farms four thousand acres in Norfolk, England. Roberto Silva works a hundred and forty in Piura, Peru. Jenn Sirp grows on a quarter acre in California. Each of them describes how the Soil Food Web Approach changed their operation by reducing inputs, creating better outputs, and improving their bottom line.

Find a trained professional near you

Our graduates who complete their certifications as consultants and lab-technicians are listed in our online directory.



Listen to our growers' stories, in their own words.

sfw.one/brochure-casestudies